



The Sagent Creed

A PHILOSOPHY OF CONSCIENCE, LIBERTY, AND LIVING ORDER

Truth is Law.

Conscience is Crown.

Every Soul is Sovereign.

THE SAGENT

Sage + Agent. One who acts from wisdom.

The Sagent is not a title claimed but a path walked. It is the one who gathers the light of many lamps into one flame—who teaches that truth is not owned but revealed, not ruled but lived.

The Sagent's fearlessness flows from surrender—acceptance of death under God's sovereignty. It brings clarity, peace, and courage. It is the opposite of the narcissist's fearlessness, which flows from ego, denial of limits, and intoxication with the self.

A Sagent acts according to conscience rather than according to special interests. A person who has principles that cannot be purchased, no matter the price, is dangerous to anyone who depends upon buying loyalty instead of earning trust.

*For every soul that ever whispered "this is not right"—
and dared to remember why.*

THE AUTHOR

Sage Arthur Jordan Clokey

Philosopher, storyteller, and seeker of divine wisdom—heir to a lineage of dreamsmiths and truth-tellers. Grandson of Art Clokey, creator of Gumby. Founder of The Spiral Steward and LivingWorks—a life-based design platform replacing industrial block-thinking with regenerative, spiral-based design.

His work spans philosophy, biology, economics, architecture, and the deep grammar of living systems. His mission is to restore the Republic of the Heart—a world without rulers, where wisdom governs through love and every soul stands sovereign before Heaven.

PROLOGUE

The Circle Without a Crown

The journey through the Eight Pillars of wisdom reveals a single law spoken in many tongues. From faith to philosophy, from East to West, every tradition bears witness: authority belongs not to rulers but to truth itself.

When conscience reigns, no man need be king. The circle completes—each pillar reflecting the same light. In this harmony of wisdom, the True Republic arises: a realm of hearts, self-governed by love, united by the law written within.

"When every heart becomes a throne, no crown is needed."

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PART ONE

The Eight Pillars of Wisdom

One truth spoken in eight tongues

- **I. Islamic Economics** — Wealth as stewardship under God. The prohibition of usury. Shared risk over guaranteed profit. *"Wealth is not owned; it is held in trust."*
- **II. The Law of Defense** — Force under conscience. The right to self-defense belongs equally to all. Violence is moral only when used to defend life, liberty, and property. *"No badge grants extra moral privilege."*
- **III. Judaism** — Kingship and covenant. Law is higher than the king. The prophets confront power with truth. The Jubilee restores economic freedom every generation. *"No accumulation can be permanent."*
- **IV. Christianity** — Grace and stewardship. Authority redeemed through service. The shepherd risks everything for the flock. The cross transforms power into sacrifice. *"Whoever would be great among you must be your servant."*
- **V. Hinduism** — Dharma and liberation. Each being has a unique duty aligned with truth. Action without attachment to reward. True freedom comes from unity with the divine. *"Better one's own duty, though imperfect, than another's done well."*
- **VI. Buddhism** — Awareness and compassion. All suffering arises from ignorance and attachment. The Middle Way between extremes. The Bodhisattva delays personal liberation to assist all beings. *"Hatred is never ended by hatred."*
- **VII. Taoism** — Natural order. The Tao governs without command. Harmony arises from alignment, not control. Wu Wei—effortless action in accordance with the nature of things. *"The more laws, the more thieves."*
- **VIII. Confucianism** — Virtue and harmony. Order begins in the heart and extends outward. The Junzi is defined by character, not birth. Self-cultivation is the foundation of governance. *"If the ruler is upright, all will be upright."*

COMMON ESSENCE

Across all eight pillars, the same law emerges: Do not initiate harm. Respect the freedom of others. Defend life, but never dominate. Order flows from conscience, not coercion.

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PART TWO

Manifesto of the True Republic

The Living Covenant

The True Republic is not a government. It is a principle: that legitimate authority rests upon conscience, not coercion. Every soul is sovereign before God. No institution, no majority, no crown can overrule the law written in the heart.

- 9. The Call to Conscience
- 10. The False Republics of Man
- 11. The Meaning of Res Publica
- 12. Natural Law and the Sovereign Soul
- 13. The Ethics of Force
- 14. The Economy of Freedom
- 15. The Republic Without Rulers
- 16. The Higher Allegiance & Vision

The health of a republic is measured not by the strength of its rulers, but by the freedom, responsibility, and conscience of its people.

The True Republic recognizes that every person possesses knowledge that no one else possesses. Every conscience encounters circumstances that no distant ruler can fully understand. If authority becomes too centralized, that local knowledge is lost, and decisions become detached from reality.

The Kingdom of Conscience is a decentralized republic. Every individual is an agent capable of moral judgment. Truth is not manufactured by hierarchy but discovered through faithful action.



PART THREE

The Path of the Sagent

True Strength, Compassion, and the Illusion of Conflict

- 17. True Strength
- 18. The Illusion of Conflict
- 19. Compassion as Power

The Sagent's path is not conquest but creation. True strength is not the ability to dominate but the refusal to be dominated—internally or externally. The Sagent acts from conscience, not from

anger. Yields where yielding serves truth. Stands where standing serves life.

Like Jedi guided by balance, Sagents act only to protect life and restore harmony, never to conquer. The strongest declaration of liberty is not merely to resist what is wrong, but to create what is right.

The first duty of free people is not conquest but creation; not destruction but renewal.

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PART FOUR

The Living Order

Essays on Life, Design, and the Shape of Freedom

20. Spirals Remember. Blocks Forget.

21. The Tree of Time

22. Bioinformatics as Stewardship

23. The Sword and the Coin

Life spirals. Empires block. The spiral stores wisdom in its form, its pattern, its recursive self-similarity. DNA remembers billions of years of evolutionary problem-solving. A healthy forest remembers every drought, every fire, every season of abundance. The spiral's memory is distributed and alive. The block's memory is centralized and brittle.

The genome is the written law of the organism. Natural genetic engineering is the continual revision of that written law. Conscience is the invisible hand of God that guides living systems toward God's concept of a plan while preserving the free will of the living.

Freedom is not the absence of order. Freedom is the possibility of living order.

THE CORE INSIGHT

Biology reveals that life is not engineered from the top down but grows through distributed adaptation. Theology reveals that God does not rule through coercion but through conscience. Economics reveals that spontaneous order emerges from voluntary action. All three point to the same truth: living order is the highest order.

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EPILOGUE

The Creed of the True Republic

The Kingdom of Heaven is not defined by land but by the people who live as agents of God. The Kingdom of Heaven is a creed of Sagents.

There are three transformations of Zion. The first is transformation by water—the flood, the famine, the parting of the sea. The second is transformation by fire—the fire of Elijah, the refining of what is corrupt from what is living. The third is transformation by spirit—the realization that Zion is not a place but a people.

*Truth before power.
Justice before advantage.
Creation before conquest.
Service before authority.*

*When every heart becomes a throne,
no crown is needed.*

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Conscience is Crown.
Every Soul is Sovereign.**

Sage Arthur Jordan Clokey • The Spiral Steward • 2026

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